9 Before the remainder of the shaping is done we need to mark the earring holes. With a pencil mark the mid-point between the two 'V' cuts you made and scorched earlier. Using your index system – or compasses if you don't have one on your lathe – mark 12 divisions around the umbrella. Centre-pop the intersects with a bradawl

10 Now we can return to shaping. At the headstock end of the blank, mark in 30mm. Now turn a sweeping curve between this point and the base of the umbrella. Try to make complete cuts to produce a flowing curve. Once completed make a 'V' cut under the umbrella to differentiate the stem from the umbrella

11 Now we can finish the umbrella section. Using a 3mm twist bit in a power drill carefully drill through at the 12 marked points. Use your fingers to support the umbrella, taking great care not to drill in to your fingers! Drill slowly and do not force the travel of the bit to ensure you do not get breakout on the underside. Now abrade – 180–400 grit – the curved section and underside of the umbrella, and then seal with cellulose sealer

12 Mark a point about 15mm to the right of the straight section of the base. Using a 4mm parting tool part in from this line until the cut is as wide as the parting tool. Now make a further cut to the left of the initial cut, approximately half the thickness of the tool – 2mm – forming a tenon 6mm deep

13 Take a 2mm parting tool and begin a parting cut on the headstock side of this tenon. You only need to go in about 10mm at this point. Now abrade the remaining 4mm of tenon edge. Keep it flat and parallel. Seal the surface

14 Continue parting off the top section of the stand. Keep the lathe speed slow and aim to fully part off the section. You want a small central reference point on the underside, so if you can stop parting at about 2mm and snap it off, all the better

15 Using a calliper record the diameter of the tenon, here it was 43mm. Transfer this dimension to the face of the portion remaining in the scroll chuck

16 Using a small parting and beading tool cut a recess to match the tenon – 43mm diameter and 4mm deep. You need to remove some of the central waste to allow for test fitting the top section. Do this carefully with a spindle gouge, making the interior slightly concave. Work carefully towards your 43mm mark test fitting the top section repeatedly until a very tight fit is achieved

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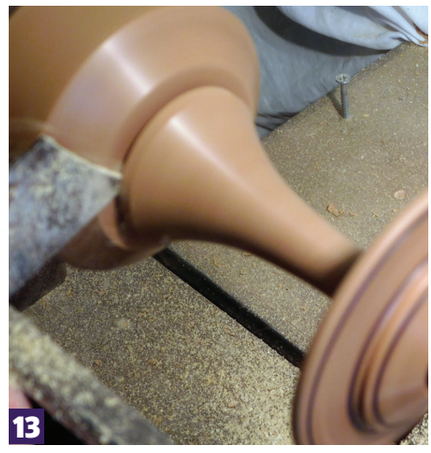
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